

Menstrual Product Comparison Chart

Feature	Pads	Tampons	Menstrual Cups	Menstrual Discs
How it works	Worn outside the body to absorb blood	Inserted into the vagina to absorb blood	Inserted into the vagina to collect blood	Inserted to sit at the base of the cervix to collect blood
Reusable	No	No	Yes (most last several years)	Some are reusable; others are disposable
How long it can be worn	3–6 hours	4–8 hours	Up to 8–12 hours*	Up to 8–12 hours*
Best for	Beginners, light to heavy flow, overnight	Moderate to heavy flow, sports, swimming	Longer wear time, sustainability	Longer wear time, comfort, some people during activity
Comfort level	External; may feel bulky	Internal; may be felt if not placed correctly	Internal; may take time to get used to	Internal; sits higher and may feel less noticeable
Risk of leaks	Moderate (depends on fit and flow)	Moderate if full or improperly placed	Low when fitted correctly	Low when positioned correctly
Risk of Toxic Shock Syndrome (TSS)	None	Very rare, but possible	Very rare when used correctly	Very rare when used correctly
Environmental impact	Single-use waste	Single-use waste	Low waste (reusable)	Low for reusable; moderate for disposable
Cost over time	Ongoing monthly cost	Ongoing monthly cost	Higher upfront, lower long-term cost	Varies by type
Learning curve	Very easy	Easy to moderate	Moderate	Moderate
Good for teens?	Yes	Yes (with guidance)	Possibly, depending on comfort	Possibly, depending on comfort

*Always follow the manufacturer’s instructions and empty or change products sooner if flow is heavy.

Key Takeaways

- **All options are safe and effective** when used as directed.
 - There is **no “best” product**—the right choice depends on comfort, lifestyle, flow, and personal preference.
 - Some people use **different products at different times** (for example, pads at night and tampons or cups during the day).
-

When to Ask for Guidance

A healthcare provider can help with:

- Choosing the right product or size
- Managing leaks or discomfort
- Understanding safe use for teens or first-time users

For additional questions or support, contact **care@yarrow.com**.